



UNSW Global
THE UNIVERSITY OF NEW SOUTH WALES
SYDNEY • AUSTRALIA

PAPER A



2014 ICAS

International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

ENGLISH

Educational Assessment Australia
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DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.

45 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.
Use a 2B or B pencil.
Do **NOT** use a pen.
Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.
Your score will be the number of correct answers.
Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **45 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–45).
Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.
On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.
Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

Earthworms eat dirt!

Earthworms help to make soil healthy.

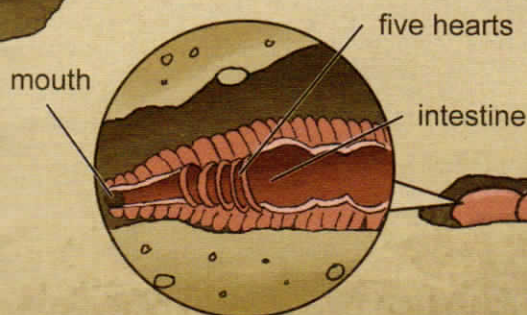
Earthworms dig long burrows in soil. They do this by eating soil and plant matter.

Earthworm burrows help plants and animals. Plant roots grow easily along the burrows and water can move along them to the plant roots. The burrows also create air spaces that help other animals to survive.

1. How do earthworm burrows help plants to grow?
 - (A) They provide food for plants.
 - (B) They help plant roots to reach the air.
 - (C) They stop other animals from reaching the plants.
 - (D) They create spaces in the soil so that plant roots can grow.
2. The word 'create', as it is used in the text, means
 - (A) follow.
 - (B) begin.
 - (C) draw.
 - (D) make.
3. In the diagram, the person is
 - (A) collecting castings.
 - (B) collecting earthworms.
 - (C) digging in the soil.
 - (D) planting flowers.
4. Birds want earthworms to think it is raining so that
 - (A) the earthworms will not drown.
 - (B) the earthworms will not dig deeper.
 - (C) the earthworms will come to the surface.
 - (D) the earthworms will make more castings.

Some people collect the castings to put on their gardens.

Earthworms breathe through their skin. Too much water in the soil means they can't breathe. They come out of their burrows in heavy rain so they don't drown. Some birds have learned to tap on the ground so earthworms think it is raining.

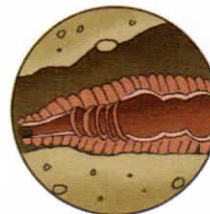


Earthworms are blind and deaf.

The soil passes through the earthworm's body and comes out as castings (worm poo). The castings help to add nutrients to the soil.

5. The purpose of this view of the worm is to show

- (A) a part of a worm in more detail.
- (B) a close-up of a worm burrow.
- (C) a detailed view of a casting.
- (D) a close-up view of a worm's skin.



6. How do earthworms make soil healthier?

- (A) by attracting birds
- (B) by adding nutrients
- (C) by eating plants
- (D) by releasing water

7. This text is mainly about

- (A) how birds trick earthworms.
- (B) which animals live in the soil.
- (C) how earthworms help to improve soil.
- (D) why plants are important to earthworms.

LOLA

I usually love waking up on a Saturday morning. On a school day it seems to take forever to find my uniform, get washed, dressed and downstairs for breakfast. But on Saturdays I can get from my bed to my breakfast in exactly fifty-three seconds! I know I can do it because I've timed it.

But today I feel a bit weird. It's like I'm in slow motion and my head feels too heavy to lift off the pillow. I can hear Mum downstairs and she sounds so cheery, like she's been up for hours. When I look at my clock, I realise why. It's 9 o'clock! She *has* been up for hours. I've wasted half of Saturday!

There is a plan for today, I'm sure. It starts with soccer. Then home for lunch before Tommy's party. I've been looking forward to it for ages. Mum has bought Tommy the best present ever. It's a science kit that shows you how to make a real rocket. He's going to love it and I know he'll ask me to help him build it. Yet, I can't seem to get out of bed.

The phone rings downstairs. I'd usually run and answer it but I feel exhausted even thinking about standing up. When Mum taps on my door a minute later, it's with bad news. Tommy's party is cancelled.

Sitting on my bed, she feels my head and then unbuttons my pyjama top to look at my super-spotty tummy. Tommy has chickenpox. And so do I!



8. Which quotation from the first paragraph tells readers that something different is going to happen to Lola?
- (A) 'I usually love waking up on a Saturday morning.'
 - (B) 'On a school day it seems to take forever to find my uniform'
 - (C) 'I can get from my bed to my breakfast in exactly fifty-three seconds!'
 - (D) 'I know I can do it'
9. Why did Lola say that she had 'wasted half of Saturday'?
- (A) She was feeling unwell.
 - (B) Her mother had forgotten to wake her up.
 - (C) She had slept in later than usual.
 - (D) Her alarm clock had not rung.
10. What do the words 'looking forward to' mean?
- (A) planning for
 - (B) ready for
 - (C) promising to go to
 - (D) excited about
11. 'Mum has bought Tommy the best present ever.'
- What is the effect of the word 'ever'?
- (A) It simplifies what happened.
 - (B) It exaggerates the statement.
 - (C) It shows Lola's determination.
 - (D) It shows that the information is important.
12. Which quotation is about something that happened in Lola's past?
- (A) 'I've timed it'
 - (B) 'It's a science kit'
 - (C) 'Yet, I can't seem to get out of bed.'
 - (D) 'The phone rings downstairs.'
13. Why was Tommy's party cancelled?
- (A) He woke up late.
 - (B) Lola could not go to the party.
 - (C) Lola had chickenpox.
 - (D) He had chickenpox.
14. What is Lola most likely to do next?
- (A) She will run down for breakfast.
 - (B) She will make the rocket.
 - (C) She will go to soccer.
 - (D) She will rest.

The Triantiwontigongolope

- There's a very funny insect that you do not often spy,
And it isn't quite a spider, and it isn't quite a fly;
It is something like a beetle, and a little like a bee,
But nothing like a woolly grub that climbs upon a tree.
- 5 Its name is quite a hard one, but you'll learn it soon, I hope.
So, try:
 Tri-
 Tri-anti-wonti
 Triantiwontigongolope.
- 10 It lives on weeds and wattle-gum, and has a funny face;
Its appetite is hearty, and its manners a disgrace.
When first you come upon it, it will give you quite a scare,
But when you look for it again you find it isn't there.
And unless you call it softly it will stay away and mope.
- 15 So, try:
 Tri-
 Tri-anti-wonti
 Triantiwontigongolope.
- 20 It trembles if you tickle it or tread upon its toes;
It is not an early riser, but it has a snubbish nose.
If you sneer at it or scold it, it will scuttle off in shame,
But it purrs and purrs quite proudly if you call it by its name,
And offer it some sandwiches of sealing-wax and soap.
- 25 So, try:
 Tri-
 Tri-anti-wonti
 Triantiwontigongolope.
- 30 But of course you haven't seen it; and I truthfully confess
That I haven't seen it either, and I don't know its address.
For there isn't such an insect, though there really might have been
If the trees and grass were purple, and the sky was bottle-green.
It's just a little joke of mine, which you'll forgive, I hope.
- 35 Oh, try:
 Try!
 Tri-anti-wonti
 Triantiwontigongolope.

C.J. Dennis

15. When the poet says 'you do not often spy' the creature, he wants readers to believe that
- (A) it is not hunted anymore.
 - (B) it is not very interesting.
 - (C) it is not very common.
 - (D) it is not good at hiding.
16. The purpose of the first three stanzas is
- (A) to explain how the creature is similar to other insects.
 - (B) to describe the creature for those who have not seen it.
 - (C) to warn readers to be careful of the creature.
 - (D) to outline the best way to track down the creature.
17. In line 14 the word 'mope' means
- (A) sulk.
 - (B) cry.
 - (C) sleep.
 - (D) disappear.
18. The poet says that the creature makes a _____ sound.
- (A) scratching
 - (B) buzzing
 - (C) purring
 - (D) chomping
19. 'If the trees and grass were purple, and the sky was bottle-green'
Why is this line included in the poem?
- (A) to indicate the type of environment the creature prefers
 - (B) to point out the place where the creature hides
 - (C) to describe a time when the creature was alive
 - (D) to show that the creature is imaginary
20. At the end of the poem, the poet apologises for
- (A) not using an easier name for the creature.
 - (B) trying to trick the reader into believing that the creature exists.
 - (C) not being able to describe the creature more accurately.
 - (D) asking the reader to search for the creature.
21. 'So, try:
Tri-
Tri-anti-wonti
Triantiwontigongolope.'
- The last four lines of each stanza are set out in this way because
- (A) it helps the reader say the creature's name.
 - (B) the creature's name is too long to fit on one line.
 - (C) it separates the three words that make up the creature's name.
 - (D) the creature's name is also the title of the poem.

Pencil power

The birth of the pencil

The story of pencils began in England more than 500 years ago. Legend says that a tree fell over in a sheep paddock in a part of England called Borrowdale. Curious shepherds found lumps of heavy, greasy, black rock lying among the tangled roots. This mysterious rock left black stuff on the shepherds' hands when they touched it. They soon found a use for it. The dirty black rock was perfect for marking their sheep.

The shepherds also found a way to stop it getting on their hands. They wrapped slabs of the black rock in sheepskin. The first pencils were born!

A name change

The shepherds who used the greasy, black rock called it *lead* because it reminded them of the metal called lead: it was about the same colour and it felt heavy. It wasn't lead, though. It wasn't even a metal. It was a rock. A German geologist (a scientist who studies rocks) called Abraham Gottlob Werner gave it a new name: *graphite*. He called it that because the ancient Greek word *graphein* means 'mark' or 'write'. So the black rod in the centre of your pencil that everyone calls 'lead' is not lead at all: it's graphite.

The magic of clay

Lumps of pure graphite like the ones the shepherds found are very rare. Therefore, to make pencils these days, rocks containing small amounts of graphite are crushed and the graphite is extracted (taken out). The graphite is then mixed with clay and made into rods. The graphite and clay rods are cooked until they're hard and dry. They are then encased in wood.

	9B		F
	7B		H
	4B		2H
	2B		4H
	B		7H
	HB		9H

B pencils have more graphite in them;
H pencils have more clay.

F pencils have fine points.

Here you can see the sort of marks they make.



22. The words 'Legend says' are used to introduce the story of the shepherds because they indicate that
- (A) only people in ancient times believed the story.
 - (B) the story should not be considered as historical fact.
 - (C) scientists are still trying to prove that the story is not true.
 - (D) the story is believed by the people who live in Borrowdale.
23. Under the subheading 'A name change', the information in the brackets () is provided to explain
- (A) what type of work a geologist does.
 - (B) how a geologist discovered graphite.
 - (C) why Abraham Werner was a famous geologist.
 - (D) how a geologist worked out that graphite was a rock.
24. According to the text, pure graphite is **NOT** used to make pencils because it is
- (A) too soft.
 - (B) too messy.
 - (C) hard to find.
 - (D) difficult to crush.
25. Subheadings are used in this text in order to
- (A) make the text more complete.
 - (B) stress that the information is accurate.
 - (C) help younger children decide what to read.
 - (D) indicate the type of information found in each section.
26. 'B pencils have more graphite in them;
H pencils have more clay.'
- What is the best way to combine the two parts of this sentence without changing its meaning?
- (A) B pencils have more graphite in them since H pencils have more clay.
 - (B) B pencils have more graphite in them whereas H pencils have more clay.
 - (C) B pencils have more graphite in them because H pencils have more clay.
 - (D) B pencils have more graphite in them although H pencils have more clay.
27. The purpose of this text is to
- (A) tell a story about the importance of pencils.
 - (B) provide information about the history of pencils.
 - (C) instruct readers on how to make a pencil at home.
 - (D) explain the importance of geologists in the discovery of pencils.



Hardly out of this world

The latest *Tyranno* movie, *Tyranno 2: Earth defence*, has just taken a nosedive and crash-landed at a cinema near you—all in 3D! While the original *Tyranno* was a visual feast with strong characters and a gripping story, *Tyranno 2* has failed miserably as so many sequels do. It is loosely based on the second book in the excellent series by Lillian Sidle, but it has mutated into a truly awful movie. In particular, parts of the plot which were significant in the book have been left out of the script. This plot-thinning has had the effect of creating characters that are somewhat one-dimensional—even if they look great in their dinosaur costumes.

Simon Gray, who did such a fabulous job in the first movie, plays Tyro. He is responsible for defending Earth from the evil pirate dinosaur Piratopod. Help with this mission is provided by a couple of velociraptor co-stars named Barry (Evan Green) and Kevin (Brian Scott). Piratopod has invented a solar-powered meteor magnet and intends to capture meteors from their space orbits, re-directing them onto a collision course with Earth. Tyro must mobilise the Earth Defence Team to locate and disable Piratopod's secret weapon. It's a typical 'good-guy-fights-bad-guy-and-overcomes-a-few-problems-along-the-way-while-winning-in-the-end' sort of movie. Usually this is a reasonable formula for success. However, the plot is mind-numbingly predictable, with gaps in the story that become obvious quite early on. This also means that the story tends to jolt strangely from one scene to the next.

I often use a 'spoiler alert' to warn readers when I intend to provide key details about a movie. In this case however, the story is so under-developed that there aren't many key details to reveal. You would think the director might have considered borrowing ideas from Sidle's books to make the characters more interesting—for instance Piratopod's twisted personality was actually explained as the result of traumatic events in his past. But no.

It is clearly in special effects that all the time and energy were invested in this movie, and if you love this sort of thing you will be enthralled. The views of Earth and the Moon are spectacular. I wasn't sitting in a cinema wearing 3D glasses; I was out there in space! Although the story is weak and the characters under-developed, the special effects are brilliant. They are the icing on a stale cake!

If the movie makers had followed Lillian Sidle's work more closely, this movie could have been a success. My suggestion to fans is to save your money on this movie and buy the book instead.



Rated: PG

Reviewed by *Lee Evan*

28. What does the word 'mutated' mean?
- (A) changed
 - (B) shifted
 - (C) progressed
 - (D) decreased
29. Why does the reviewer describe the characters as 'one-dimensional'?
- (A) This is how the characters are portrayed in the book.
 - (B) The actors did not have the experience to play the parts.
 - (C) There is a lack of character development in the movie.
 - (D) The characters are played by unknown actors in the movie.
30. What is a 'spoiler alert'?
- (A) a suggestion to change the plot
 - (B) a hint that a negative comment will be made
 - (C) a warning that key parts of the plot will be exposed
 - (D) a clue that links the movie with the book
31. The word 'enthralled' means
- (A) curious. (B) fascinated. (C) puzzled. (D) amused.
32. Which statement would the reviewer most likely agree with?
- (A) The audience will disregard the changes to the storyline.
 - (B) The changes in the plot weakened the special effects.
 - (C) The cast was more inexperienced than expected.
 - (D) The movie was more show than substance.
33. What is the main technique used by the reviewer to persuade readers not to watch the movie?
- (A) describing what it is like to view the movie in 3D
 - (B) exaggerating the strengths of the book
 - (C) contrasting the movie with the book
 - (D) including humour
34. The overall tone of the review is
- (A) angry.
 - (B) rude.
 - (C) dissatisfied.
 - (D) arrogant.

The old shopkeeper

We'd only lived in the street for a week when my mother sent me down to the corner shop on an errand. I'd already heard the horror stories about the shopkeeper. The kids from school called him Groucho.

That day, for the first time, I stepped from the bright warmth of the street into the musty, arctic gloom of the corner shop.

'What do you want, boy?' It wasn't so much a voice as the rumbling from a bottomless volcano.

A sharp thrill of panic spread through my body and in a rush, all the schoolyard stories came back to me. Two boys that Groucho had caught stealing a bar of chocolate now felt very ill whenever they saw or smelled chocolate. Without being seen, Groucho could sneak up on you like a vampire, floating silently from the other end of the shop. He'd just appear at your shoulder and ask what you were doing.

'My mother' was all I could manage to choke out.

I saw the ranks of milk inside the door of the tall fridge and with hands that felt like feet, I fumbled a bottle onto the counter and began tugging coins from my pocket. As my sweaty

fingers grappled with the stubborn silver, I made the mistake of looking up.

Groucho was not so much clothed as swathed in odd rags and small blankets against the cold. They were grubby and stringy at the edges and looked as if he slept in them. He wore a strange old purple woollen cap that exactly matched the colour of his gigantic lumpy nose. The lines in his face were as deep as cracks in the pavement and his teeth jutted out at all angles like the stubs of yellow crayons. Although his eyes were a deep black, as he leaned down to stare at me, tiny glints of light danced and revolved like distant galaxies. The old hands that rested in front of him were the grimy claws of some prehistoric bird of prey.

I tried to place my money on the counter but I was already moving for the door. The coins jangled in the silence and I heard one make a burring roll and clang on the floor. I hit the door hard, forgetting it opened inward, then tore it back and burst into the sunshine clutching the milk against my pounding chest as I finally remembered to breathe.



35. Why did the narrator enter the shop?
- (A) to confirm the horror stories he had heard from school
 - (B) to show the kids from school that he was brave
 - (C) to see what Groucho looked like
 - (D) to buy milk for his mother
36. How did the narrator feel when the shopkeeper spoke to him?
- (A) terrified
 - (B) guilty
 - (C) irritated
 - (D) disappointed
37. The schoolyard stories about the shopkeeper most likely started because
- (A) children told them so their parents would shop elsewhere.
 - (B) children invented them to scare each other.
 - (C) the narrator's mother told them because she disliked Groucho.
 - (D) Groucho told them to frighten the children who visited his shop.
38. The word 'swathed' means that the things Groucho wore
- (A) looked like they were tied together.
 - (B) were now old and unclean.
 - (C) were wrapped in layers around him.
 - (D) matched the appearance of the shop.
39. The narrator provides a description of the shopkeeper's appearance in order to
- (A) express his frustration with the shopkeeper.
 - (B) convince readers to have sympathy for the shopkeeper.
 - (C) reveal his resentment towards the shopkeeper.
 - (D) justify his beliefs about the shopkeeper.
40. What is the main effect of the very long last sentence?
- (A) It suggests that time passed slowly for the narrator.
 - (B) It reinforces the idea that the narrator was in a state of panic.
 - (C) It highlights how much the narrator had thought about this event.
 - (D) It emphasises that too many things happened for the narrator to remember.
41. How would the narrator have felt immediately after he left the shop?
- (A) relief at being outside
 - (B) nervous about returning to the shop
 - (C) angry that he dropped his money
 - (D) troubled by the way he was treated

THE NIGHT NOODLE MARKET

I was slightly puzzled when Mum mentioned that she wanted to take us to the Night Noodle Market in the city. I knew what noodles were but what were 'night noodles', I wondered. Did they glow in the dark? Were they only able to be eaten (42) the evening?

'It's like a picnic at night,' Mum explained. 'There are stalls selling noodles (43) other kinds of Asian-style food.' I was convinced! My younger brother needed some help (44) the idea though ...

'Mum?'

'Yes, Thomas.'

'Will the night noodles (45) scary? I think I only like day noodles.'

42. (A) by
(B) on
(C) from
(D) in
43. (A) caused by
(B) resulting in
(C) as well as
(D) because of
44. (A) to
(B) with
(C) beside
(D) over
45. (A) be
(B) being
(C) were
(D) are



E

2014 English Answer Keys

ICAS

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Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	D	D	A	C	D	C	C	D
2	D	C	B	C	C	A	A	C
3	A	D	C	B	A	B	B	A
4	C	A	B	C	A	C	D	B
5	A	D	B	D	B	B	A	C
6	B	A	D	C	D	D	D	A
7	C	C	B	A	C	D	B	B
8	A	D	A	D	A	C	D	A
9	C	D	C	B	C	B	C	D
10	D	A	D	A	D	C	A	B
11	B	B	A	D	A	D	B	B
12	A	A	B	C	C	A	C	C
13	D	D	C	A	D	B	A	C
14	D	A	D	D	C	A	D	B
15	C	C	A	B	B	C	B	D
16	B	C	D	B	C	D	A	B
17	A	B	B	D	D	A	B	D
18	C	D	D	B	A	C	D	A
19	D	C	B	D	B	D	A	C
20	B	C	C	C	A	A	C	D
21	A	D	A	C	A	D	D	B
22	B	A	B	D	D	B	A	A
23	A	A	B	A	D	D	C	B
24	C	B	D	D	B	D	C	C
25	D	B	C	B	C	C	D	D
26	B	B	C	D	B	A	D	B
27	B	D	A	B	A	C	C	C
28	A	D	A	C	B	B	B	B
29	C	A	C	A	C	C	C	A
30	C	B	C	B	A	A	A	D

(Please turn over)



E

2014 English Answer Keys

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Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
31	B	B	B	C	D	B	B	C
32	D	D	A	A	B	B	B	A
33	C	C	D	D	C	C	C	D
34	C	C	A	B	B	A	D	B
35	D	A	D	C	A	B	C	D
36	A	A	A	B	C	A	D	C
37	B	B	D	B	D	D	B	A
38	C	C	B	D	B	A	B	D
39	D	A	A	A	D	D	A	A
40	B	C	C	A	C	D	B	B
41	A	C	D	C	A	C	C	C
42	D	A	C	A	A	D	A	D
43	C	C	A	A	B	C	D	A
44	B	C	A	B	C	C	C	B
45	A	B	C	A	B	A	D	C
46			C	B	C	B	B	A
47			D	C	D	A	D	D
48			A	D	A	B	C	C
49			D	D	D	D	A	A
50			D	A	D	D	D	D
51					D	A	A	B
52					B	B	B	C
53					D	D	C	A
54					B	C	B	B
55					A	A	D	C
56							A	D
57							B	D
58							C	B
59							D	C
60							A	A

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